the feeling that women, after doing their research and getting their degrees, would then get married, have children, and retire into domesticity—and they would have taken up the place that some man could have used to get his degrees and become a working scientist. (Naturally, I was thinking of Irene.)

Gerry argued this point strenuously and, when it seemed that justice was on her side, I gave up. She went on to get her Ph.D., then married a fellow researcher, had children, and retired into domesticity—at least for a while.

There was James Mann, who shared my research lab at the start. He resembled Tyrone Power in looks (in my eyes, anyway), was a very pleasant fellow and, after a while, joined the Unitarian Church. He was a nonobservant Jew and he urged me to find the same spiritual home, but I refused firmly. I intended to be a nonobservant everything.

16

Apparently our family had Americanized itself into birthday presents. At least on December 7, 1946, my mother bestowed upon me a wristwatch as an advance gift of that sort.

It pleased me at the time, and the remarkable thing, in my opin-

ion, is that I still have it. It's been cleaned innumerable times and has been repaired on occasion, and its face is so dark the numbers are hard to read—but it still works, and I still use it on occasion.

*7

On December 10, I got a letter from Gerry Cohen to the effect that he had been discharged and was a civilian again.

Each time someone I knew in the Army reported he was out, I felt that another link with that deplorable episode in my life had been cut. I was getting to feel that not only the Army, but also the Navy Yard had been a kind of extraneous intrusion upon my life. Those years began to seem, as they have seemed ever since, far less real to me than the years before 1942 and since 1946.

18

I feel that, as a matter of principle, I ought to record every piece of egregious Asimovian stupidity I can remember, if only to have it act as a partial